

Carns National School

Visual Arts

Ratified by Board Date: _____

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Introduction

Art is a way of making and communicating meaning through imagery. It is a unique symbolic domain and is a discipline with its own particular demands and core of learning. Art is a natural and enjoyable way of extending and enriching the child's experience of the world.

Visual arts activities enable the child to make connections between the imaginative life and the world and to organise and express ideas, feelings and experiences in visual, tangible form. In drawing, painting, constructing and inventing, the child assimilates and responds to experience and tries to make sense of it.

Visual arts education provides for creative and aesthetic experiences through exploring, investigating, experimenting, inventing, designing and making in a range of media. It promotes observation and ways of seeing and helps the child to acquire sensitivity to the visual, spatial and tactile world and to aesthetic experience. Visual arts education channels the child's natural curiosity for educational ends: the development of perceptual awareness helps the child to enjoy and interpret the visual environment and art works and can facilitate learning in all areas of the curriculum. Creative achievements in art contribute to a sense of personal identity and self-esteem and help to create cultural awareness and empathy.

The curriculum suggests the following as accessible media for expression through which the child can explore, respond to and interpret the world visually:

- *Drawing*
- *Paint and colour*
- *Print*
- *Clay*
- *Construction*
- *Fabric and fibre.*

The visual arts in a child-centred curriculum

Each child possesses a range of intelligences and he/she needs a variety of learning experiences in order to develop them fully. Visual arts activities enable children to make sense of and to express their world in visual, tangible form. They can also be unifying forces in children's learning and development: drawing, painting, inventing and constructing bring together different elements of children's experience from which a whole new experience can develop. Understanding visual imagery opens additional ways of learning for children and enables them to record real or imagined ideas and feelings. Opportunities to explore and investigate the visual elements in their environment help them to appreciate the nature of things and to channel their natural curiosity for educational ends. The confidence and enjoyment

that stem from purposeful visual arts activities can have a positive effect on children's learning in other areas of the curriculum.

Children who have had experience in exploring and experimenting with a variety of art materials and media are likely, as they develop, to produce art that is personal. Carns N.S. endeavours to develop a quality visual arts programme ensuring that each child has a variety of enriching visual arts experiences in both two and three dimensional media.

Aims

- ▶ to help the child develop sensitivity to the visual, spatial and tactile world, and to provide for aesthetic experience
- ▶ to help the child express ideas, feelings and experiences in visual and tactile forms
- ▶ to enable the child to have enjoyable and purposeful experiences of different art media and to have opportunities to explore, experiment, imagine, design, invent and communicate with different art materials
- ▶ to promote the child's understanding of and personal response to the creative processes involved in making two and three-dimensional art
- ▶ to enable the child to develop the skills and techniques necessary for expression, inventiveness and individuality
- ▶ to enable the child to experience the excitement and fulfilment of creativity and the achievement of potential through art activities
- ▶ to foster sensitivity towards and enjoyment and appreciation of the visual arts
- ▶ to provide opportunities for the child to explore how the work of artists and craftspeople might relate to his/her own work.

Objectives

- ▶ look at, enjoy and make a personal response to a range of familiar and unfamiliar objects and images in the environment, focusing on their visual attributes
- ▶ explore and begin to develop sensitivity to qualities of line, shape, colour and tone, texture, pattern and rhythm, spatial organisation and the three-dimensional quality of form
- ▶ express ideas, feelings and experiences in visual form and with imagination, enjoyment and a sense of fulfilment
- ▶ experiment in spontaneous, imaginative and increasingly structured ways with a range of art materials, including pencils, paints, crayons, chalks, markers, inks, clay, papier m.ch., fabric and fibre, and construction materials
- ▶ explore the expressive and design possibilities of the materials within a range of two and three-dimensional media, including drawing, paint and colour, print, clay, construction, fabric and fibre
- ▶ apply skills and techniques, demonstrating increasing sensitivity to the visual elements in his/her art work
- ▶ look with curiosity and openness at the work of a wide range of artists and craftspeople
- ▶ explore atmosphere, content and impact in the work of artists, especially when they relate to his/her own work
- ▶ identify a variety of visual arts media and describe some of the creative processes involved
- ▶ develop an ability to identify and discuss what he/she considers the most important design elements of individual pieces, especially when they relate to work in hand
- ▶ discuss the preferred design elements in his/her work and in the work of classmates
- ▶ begin to appreciate the context in which great art and artefacts are created and the culture from which they grow
- ▶ respond to visual arts experiences in a variety of imaginative ways
- ▶ use appropriate language in responding to visual arts experiences.

Organisation

Visual Arts has been organised to ensure that the children have access to all six strands as specified in the Primary visual arts curriculum.

Resources

Carns N.S. school has access to a variety of visual arts materials resources including books and websites. A regular and adequate supply of materials and tools is essential for building on staff interest and enthusiasm and supplying staff with all necessary resources to deliver the six strands proficiently.

Carns N.S. also take into account ancillary resources, such as cleaning materials, display and storage space. Carns NS also facilitates involvement in community/educational arts projects. To date we have undertaken work with Craft Ed., Punc 101 with the Model Niland Gallery and Kids Own Publishing along with the Spanish Armada Grange project and local and National art competitions. We continue to participate regularly in Arts programmes and visit the Model Niland Gallery when the opportunity arises.

Planning

The Visual Arts curriculum at Carns N.S. aims to emphasise the following;

- understanding the creative process children go through in making art
- understanding the stages of development in children's art and their relevance for drawing in particular
- the provision of a broad, six-strand curriculum to which drawing is central and which incorporates art, craft and design activities in a balance of two- and three dimensional media
- balancing opportunities to make art with opportunities to look at and make a personal response to art.

Carns N.S. also values highly the creative process. We believe that in making art, the *process of making* is as valuable as the final product.

Display

Carns N.S. has a variety of display boards and areas within in the school. These areas for display are in the classrooms, corridors and SEN room. The importance of display, appreciation and discussion are highly valued at Carns.

Staff involvement

At Carns N.S. the principal and staff regard Visual Arts as an important feature of the curriculum and as a fundamental part of learning.

Differentiation

All children should have equal access to visual arts education.

Teachers always differentiate in their planning, aims, content and methodologies..

Time allocation

The time allocated to Visual Arts meets the requirements outlined in the Primary Visual Arts Curriculum. Visual arts is can also be integrated into other subject areas.

Assessment tools

Assessment in art should show how children are learning to perceive, explore, respond to and express their world through the curriculum strands.

Assessment methods at Carns N.S. include the following;

- teacher observation
- teacher-designed tasks
- work samples, portfolios and projects
- curriculum profiles.

In the process of making and responding to art, the child may demonstrate qualities of imagination, inventiveness and involvement which can be observed at the time but may not be evident in a finished piece of work, or may not be recalled easily. Teacher observation, therefore, is considered an important assessment tool at Carns N.S.

Areas for assessment include:

- the child's ability to choose and use materials, tools and media for a particular task or project, effectively and with originality
- the child's expressive use of visual media in compositions and in developing form
- the quality of the child's responses to art works, and his/her ability to make connections between his/her own work and the work of others
- the child's approach to and level of involvement with a task
- the child's contribution to group activity.

Integration

Visual arts activities that involve linkage and integration to other subjects give the children added opportunities for creativity and inventiveness and to enable them to show strengths and develop interests.

Activities that integrate the visual arts with other subjects at Carns N.S., should be well planned to help extend children's understanding of both art and the other subjects, and not merely for illustrative purposes. Integrative subjects include, English, Maths, SESE, Aistear, SPHE and Music.